About the failure of the media to initiate a far- reaching inquiry, Gouri Chatterjee wrote in the *Telegraph:* 'The media's unquestioning acceptance of whatever the police fed them, no, directed them to say, and their complicity in the government's scheme of things are downright embarrassing.'[10]

Rajat Roy (*Anandabazar Patrika*) illustrated the complicity of the media with the police by recounting in detail the event of Afzal's forced confession before the media.[11] Subhendu Dasgupta (*EPW*, 22 July 2006) summed up the complicity as follows: 'The truth that the media presented was incomplete, partial, truncated, engineered and designed, and the judgement was made on the basis of this truth. The media came to its judgement before the judicial process started. The administrative truth was passed on to the media; the media took the official truth and transformed it into "media truth".'[12] Notice that Dasgupta maintained this nearly one year after the judgement of the Supreme Court.

Commenting on the entire episode in her article in the *Telegraph*, Gouri Chatterjee observed that 'the greater tragedy is, we are condemned to repeat all this the next time round too'.[13] After the judgement, Sukumar Muralidharan expanded on these themes (*Biblio*). 'The December 13 event,' Muralidharan observed, 'proved the pivot from which momentous consequences followed. These involved issues of war and peace, the security and well-being of the peoples of India and Pakistan, and the posture that national governments in the two countries would adopt towards the global struggle being waged between what was "civilization" and its supposed antithesis.'[14]

Needless to say, none of these momentous issues can be addressed without ascertaining the facts surrounding the event. More specifically, as Muralidharan puts it, 'a well-informed citizenry obviously owes itself the duty of unravelling the facts behind the attack on a central institution of its democracy. And an indispensable part of the process of ascertaining [the] facts would be to establish the motivations that led the Delhi Police into its sordid saga of fabrication.'[15]

After describing Afzal's predicaments as a surrendered militant, Muralidharan writes, 'Any Indian citizen with a basic level of civic involvement would be assailed by a number of questions if she were to take the statements by Afzal in their entirety.'[16] He goes on to say, quoting from a recent book on the subject: 'Indeed, the conclusions that any observer who has not surrendered his critical faculties to the cult of the nation state would